VOLUME 3 — DRAWING & CREATIVE PREPARATION

> **The single most important truth:** NID does **not** reward photorealism. It rewards **clear thinking made visible**: observation, ideas, storytelling, empathy, composition and communication. A confident, well-observed, slightly rough drawing with a strong idea beats a polished drawing of a weak idea. [INFERRED from the nature of NID questions and consistent with NID's stated aims]

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1. What NID examiners are likely looking for [INFERRED]

Criterion	What it means	Self-check question
Observation	Real-life details that make a drawing believable	"Would someone from this place recognise it?"
Idea quality	A thoughtful, relevant interpretation	"Is my idea better than the first thing everyone thinks of?"
Originality	A personal, unexpected angle	"Would 100 other students draw this?"
Communication	The message is clear in about 5 seconds	"Can someone explain my drawing back to me?"
Composition	The frame is used well; there is a focal point	"Where does the eye land first?"
Proportion	Correct relative sizes	"Is the person taller than the door? (They shouldn't be.)"
Clarity	Clean lines; labels where useful	"Is anything confusing?"
Storytelling	Action, emotion, cause and effect	"What is happening, and why?"
Problem-solving	A solution that fits the user and context	"Does it actually solve the problem for this user?"

2. Tools & materials (exam kit)

- **Pencils:** HB (construction), 2B (outlines), 4B–6B (dark accents).
- **Eraser:** a plastic eraser plus a kneaded eraser (to lift highlights).
- **Black fine-liners:** 0.3 and 0.5 mm, for confident final lines.

- **Colour:** 24-shade colour pencils (layer them; don't press hard at first) and oil pastels (for big areas and posters). Use sketch pens for posters only, sparingly.
- **Other:** a 30 cm scale, a sharpener, and a watch (if permitted).
- **Practice paper:** an A4 sketchbook (80–100 sheets) plus newsprint for warm-ups.

3. Core drawing skills

3.1 Line quality

- **What:** confident, varied lines. Thick lines for outlines and near objects; thin for details and distance.
- **Rule:** draw from the shoulder or elbow for long lines and from the wrist for details. Use "ghosting": move the hand over the line path 2–3 times, then draw it.
- **Exercises:**
    1. Fill a page with parallel straight lines (horizontal, vertical, diagonal), 5 minutes daily for 2 weeks.
    2. Draw 50 ellipses of different sizes in boxes.
    3. Line-weight drill: redraw a simple cup, varying the weight (heavy on the shadow side and contact points).

3.2 Shapes & forms

- Everything can be built from **cubes, cylinders, spheres and cones**. A pressure cooker = cylinder + dome + a handle (an elongated box). A bus = a long box. A person = an oval head + a box torso + cylinder limbs.
- **Exercises:**
    1. Draw 10 household objects, starting from basic forms.
    2. Rotate a cube in 6 positions.
    3. Combine 2 forms into a new object (e.g. a cylinder + a cone becomes a lamp).

3.3 Proportion

- **Sight-size and measuring:** use a pencil at arm's length to compare heights and widths.
- **Human proportions:** an adult is about **7.5–8 heads tall**; a child of 5–6 years is about 5–6 heads. The halfway point of an adult is the hips/crotch. With arms down, the fingertips reach mid-thigh.
- **Indian context references:**

Object	Approximate size
Door	2.1 m
Auto-rickshaw	~1.7 m tall, 2.6 m long
Two-wheeler	~1.1 m tall
Cycle-rickshaw seat	~0.9 m
Bus	~3 m tall
Chair seat	~0.45 m
Table	~0.75 m
Kitchen platform	~0.85 m

- **Exercise:** draw a person standing beside a door, an auto, a scooter and a bus (4 small studies). Check the ratios against the table.

3.4 Light & shadow (more in §7)

- Identify the **light source**. Shade the planes facing away. Add the **cast shadow** on the ground, opposite the light.
- Elements: highlight, light, halftone, core shadow, reflected light, cast shadow.
- **Exercise:** draw a sphere, a cube and a cylinder lit from the top-left; render them with a 5-value scale.

4. Perspective scenes (VERY HIGH priority)

The 6-step scene method (15–20 minutes)

1. **Decide the story** (30 sec): "Evening vegetable market; a vendor weighs tomatoes for an old woman."
2. **Draw the horizon line** at eye level. Place a VP (1-point) or 2 VPs (2-point).
3. **Block in big shapes:** buildings, road, stalls, as boxes in perspective.
4. **Add people:** heads on the HL for standing adults; place them at different depths (foreground, mid-ground, background). Overlap them.
5. **Add details that tell the story:** weighing scale, tomatoes, cloth bag, price board in Hindi/English, stray dog, bicycle, wires, light bulbs on the stalls.
6. **Finish:** a darker line weight in front, light tone or colour, shadows consistent with the light source.

Scene checklist: focal action ✓ · 3 depth layers ✓ · 5+ people with different actions ✓ · context details ✓ · consistent light ✓.

Exercises (do 1 per day, rotating):

#	Scene	Perspective
1	A railway platform with a train arriving	1-point
2	Your classroom from the last bench	1-point
3	A street corner tea stall	2-point
4	A three-storey building cut open (a section view showing life on each floor)	1-point frontal, stacked
5	A busy bus stop during rain	2-point
6	A crowded temple or mosque entrance during a festival	1-point
7	A hospital waiting area	2-point
8	A rooftop on Makar Sankranti (kite festival)	3-point (bird's-eye)
9	A view looking up at a metro bridge	3-point (worm's-eye)
10	A narrow lane in an old city (like Varanasi)	1-point, steep

The "three-storey scene" (reported in DAT 2026): draw a building in **section** (front wall removed, like a doll's house). Show a different activity on each floor: a shop on the ground floor, a family dinner on the 1st, a student studying on the 2nd, and a terrace with clothes drying and water tanks. Connect the floors with a staircase showing a person moving between levels: that creates the story. Keep the floor heights consistent (about 3 m, so about 1.7 people tall per floor).

5. Viewpoints & imagination

Viewpoint	How to draw	Example prompt
Bird's-eye	High horizon (or off the page); 3rd VP below; we see tops of heads and roofs	"Your street as seen by a kite"
Worm's / ant's-eye	Very low horizon; 3rd VP above; huge foreground objects	"A cricket match seen by an ant on the pitch"
Crow's-view (DAT 2025 poster)	Elevated, slightly angled; a crow's perspective	"Poster for an orange juice corner from a crow's view"
Through an object	A frame within the frame	"The world seen through a keyhole / a spectacle lens"
Microscopic	Exaggerated scale; textures become landscapes	"A day in the life of a dust particle on your desk"
Inside an object	A cutaway	"Inside a pressure cooker"
Emotional viewpoint	Distortion that conveys feeling	"The exam hall as seen by a nervous student"

Imagination drills:

- "What if" prompts: what if buildings could walk?
- Combine 2 objects into 1 creature.
- Show a familiar place 100 years in the future.
- Personify objects: the life of a forgotten umbrella.

6. Human figures, faces, hands, expressions, gestures

6.1 Gesture & stick figures (most important for scenes)

- Start with the **line of action**, a single curve showing the pose's energy.
- Then draw a **bean** torso (chest + pelvis with a twist), oval head, cylinder limbs, and simple hands and feet.
- **Exercise:** 30-second gestures × 20 daily (people in videos, family members, or photos of crowds).

6.2 Body proportions & poses

- Draw standing, sitting (cross-legged on the floor, a common Indian pose), squatting, walking, running, bending, lifting, carrying a load on the head, cycling, and riding pillion.
- **Balance rule:** for a standing figure, the head is roughly above the weight-bearing foot.

6.3 Faces & expressions

- Face proportions: the eyes sit halfway down the head; the nose halfway between the eyes and the chin; the mouth a third of the way from nose to chin.
- **Expressions via eyebrows + mouth:**

Emotion	Eyebrows	Mouth
Happy	relaxed	upturned
Sad	inner ends raised	down
Angry	inner ends down (V-shape)	tight or showing teeth
Surprised	high	open "O"

Emotion	Eyebrows	Mouth
Afraid	raised and tense	stretched
Disgust	lowered	upper lip raised, nose wrinkled

- **Exercise:** a 6-emotion grid with the same character, daily for a week.

6.4 Hands

- Treat the hand as a **mitten** shape first, then split the fingers. The palm is about as long as the middle finger.
- **Exercise:** draw your non-drawing hand in 10 poses (gripping a cup, pointing, holding a phone, fist, writing).

6.5 Indian people & clothing details

Saree pleats, kurta, dhoti, salwar, school uniforms, turbans (regional styles), a gamchha on the shoulder, chappals, a police uniform, a vendor's apron, a construction worker's helmet, a doctor's coat.

7. Light, shadow, texture & material representation

Material	How to show it
Glass	Strong, sharp highlights; see-through background with slight distortion; reflections at the edges
Polished metal (steel tiffin)	High contrast; reflected surroundings as bands; bright highlights next to dark
Matte plastic	Soft gradients; small soft highlights
Wood	Grain lines following the form; warm tones
Fabric	Folds radiating from points of tension (shoulders, knees); soft shadows
Water	Horizontal reflections; ripples; transparency
Terracotta / clay	Matte, warm; rough stippled texture
Concrete / stone	Speckle texture; cracks
Rubber	Dark, matte; soft highlights
Leaves / foliage	Clusters rather than single leaves; light on top, dark beneath

Exercise: draw the same cylinder in 6 materials: glass, steel, wood, clay, fabric-covered and rubber.

8. Product sketching & redesign (VERY HIGH priority)

8.1 The 5-step redesign method ("PUCIS")

1. **P**roblem: list 4–6 problems with the current product (observe users).
2. **U**ser: who is the user? Age, abilities, context (e.g. an elderly user on a train).
3. **C**onstraints: cost, material, manufacturing, space, electricity, water, culture.
4. **I**deas: 3 thumbnail concepts, each 1–2 minutes.
5. **S**ketch the selected concept: a big main view (3/4 perspective) + 1–2 detail views + labels + a small "in use" scene + a 1–2 line justification.

8.2 Product sketch layout for an answer box

```
+-------------------------------------------------------+
|  TITLE: "EasyPour Pressure Cooker for Elderly Users"   |
|  [Problems: 1. heavy  2. hot handle  3. whistle fear]  |
|                                                        |
|        [ BIG 3/4 VIEW OF PRODUCT ]      [detail 1]     |
|          labels with arrows →           [detail 2]     |
|                                                        |
|  [small in-use scene: user lifting with two handles]   |
|  Materials: ...    How it helps: ...                   |
+-------------------------------------------------------+
```

8.3 Product sketching technique

- Use 3/4 view (two-point) for most products; add a front or side elevation if helpful.
- Ghost the construction lines lightly, then darken the final silhouette.
- Show **mechanisms** with arrows (rotate, slide, fold) and **exploded views** for assembly.
- Show **scale** by adding a hand holding the product.

8.4 Products to practise redesigning (common Indian context)

pressure cooker · bucket and mug · water bottle for school kids · school bag · auto-rickshaw seat · bus stop · street-vendor cart · tiffin · steel almirah · ceiling fan cleaning · chappal · umbrella · gas cylinder trolley · clothes-drying stand for balconies · walking stick · pill organiser · broom · dustbin with segregation · railway berth ladder · hospital stretcher · temple shoe stand · public water tap · mobile charging kiosk · tea kettle for a chaiwala · kite spool (charkha) · rangoli tool · bicycle carrier.

9. Visual communication

9.1 Poster process (20–35 min)

1. **Message** in one sentence ("Drink fresh orange juice at Sunny Corner").
2. **Audience & tone** (kids? commuters? fun or serious?).
3. **Big idea:** a visual metaphor or twist (the orange as the sun, seen by a crow from above).
4. **Thumbnails:** 3 layouts at 3×4 cm.
5. **Final:** headline (big, 3–6 words), one dominant image, a supporting line, a call to action and logo, a limited palette (3–4 colours), and clear hierarchy.

Visual metaphor bank:

- Earth as a melting ice cream (climate)
- A tree with lungs as foliage (air)
- A tap dripping hourglass sand (water scarcity)
- A pencil as a rocket (education)
- A seat belt as a hug (road safety)

9.2 Logo / symbol process

1. Brainstorm keywords (the name, values, activity).
2. Look for **double meanings and negative space**.
3. Draw 10 quick thumbnails.
4. Select and refine using geometric construction.
5. Test it small (1 cm) and in black and white.

6. Show the final in colour plus one application (signboard, cup, app icon).

9.3 Signage set (e.g. "5 signboards for narrow streets," DAT 2026)

- Use a **consistent system**: the same shape family, colour code, icon style and font.
- Show the **sign in context**: one small drawing of a sign mounted in the lane, at a believable height.
- Prioritise icons with minimal bilingual text.

9.4 Packaging

- Show a dieline (net) + the 3D form + the front panel design + the opening mechanism.
- Consider protection, stacking, the user's grip, reuse after use, and material (paper, cloth, leaf).

10. Sequential drawing & visual storytelling (VERY HIGH priority)

Rules

1. **Plan the beats first:** setup → problem → action → resolution (4 frames), or add build-up frames for 6.
2. **Continuity:** the same character design (clothes, hair, props) and setting in every frame.
3. **Vary the shots:** wide (establishing), medium (action), close-up (emotion or detail).
4. **Use the 180° rule:** keep the camera on one side of the action, so characters don't swap sides.
5. **Show emotion** through faces and body language.
6. **Minimal text:** captions of 3–6 words if allowed; speech bubbles are sparing.
7. **Number the frames** and keep the reading order left→right, top→bottom.

Worked plan: "Helping an elderly person who falls during a morning walk" (DAT 2026, reported)

Frame	Shot	Content
1	Wide	A park at dawn, joggers, an elderly man walking with a stick; a loose paving stone visible (foreshadowing)
2	Medium	He trips on the stone; the stick flies; a young girl notices
3	Close-up	His pained face; the girl kneels and asks "Are you okay?"; her phone in hand
4	Medium	She helps him sit on a bench; another walker brings water; she calls his family / 108 ambulance
5	Medium	Family arrives; gratitude; the girl smiles
6	Wide / epilogue	Next morning, the paving stone is fixed and a "Mind your step" sign is placed: the systemic solution. This shows design thinking.

Exercises: 2 stories per week from the prompt bank (§13, category C).

11. Memory drawing

- **What:** drawing objects, places or events from memory, accurately and with characteristic details.
- **Method:** recall the overall form → key proportions → the defining details (logo position, buttons, joints) → the context of use.
- **Weekly drill:** draw 5 objects from memory, then compare them with reality and circle the errors in red. Common subjects:
  - pressure cooker
  - ceiling fan
  - auto-rickshaw
  - bicycle (chain on the right; pedals; seat; stand)

    - school bench
    - railway coach interior
    - steel glass
    - matchbox
    - water cooler
    - post box (red, cylindrical)
    - traffic signal
    - gas stove
    - street lamp
    - your own house's entrance
- **Food illustration (DAT 2026: shikanji / thandai):** show the vessel (steel glass or kulhad), the ingredients around it (lemon slices, mint, ice, black salt; for thandai: almonds, saffron, rose petals, fennel), condensation droplets, the serving context (a street cart, a Holi setting), and labels. Colour helps a lot here.

12. Mains preparation

12.1 Studio Sensitivity Test

Skills:

- clay modelling (pinch, coil, slab)
- paper engineering (folding, pop-up, scoring, curling)
- wire forms
- found-object assemblage
- material textures

Weekly practice (start right after Prelims, or earlier on weekends):

1. Clay: model 3 animals in different expressions (30 min).
2. Paper: create a structure that holds a 500 g weight using only 2 A4 sheets.
3. Wire: make a figure showing movement (dancing, running).
4. Theme models: "Peace", "Speed", "Friendship", "Growth", "Balance". Interpret abstractly and literally.
5. Explain each model in 3 lines (concept, material choice, what it shows).

Evaluation logic [INFERRED]: concept + craft + material sensitivity + use of time.

12.2 In-Person Sensitivity Test (interview-style)

Prepare answers (spoken, 1–2 min each) for:

1. Why design? Why NID?
2. Which discipline and why?
3. A product you love or hate, and why. Have a redesign idea ready.
4. A craft from your state: its process, the community, its challenges.
5. A recent design or architecture news item (Vol 11).
6. Your hobbies and what you observe through them.
7. A problem in your city you would like to solve.
8. Your Studio Test model: explain it.

Tips: be honest; think aloud; give specific examples; it's fine to say "I don't know, but I think...".

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13. THE 110-PROMPT SUBJECTIVE BANK

Each prompt lists: **Consider** (what to think about) · **Composition** · **Idea strategy** · **Common mistakes** · **Evaluation criteria**. Suggested time: 15–25 min each unless stated. The "Evaluation" line names what an examiner would look for. Use it to self-score out of 10.

A. Draw from Memory / Observation (A1–A12)

A1. Draw a pressure cooker from memory, showing how the whistle works.

- Consider: body, lid with gasket, handle(s), whistle weight, safety valve, base.
- Composition: a large 3/4 view + a cutaway of the whistle/vent.
- Idea: a cutaway with steam arrows.
- Mistakes: forgetting the gasket and safety valve; the handle on the wrong side.
- Evaluation: accuracy, mechanism clarity, labels, proportion.

A2. Draw the inside of a railway sleeper coach from the aisle.

- Consider: berths (upper, middle, lower, side), ladder, windows with bars, fans, chains, luggage, passengers.
- Composition: 1-point perspective down the aisle.
- Idea: show a story, e.g. a family sharing food.
- Mistakes: incorrect berth arrangement; a flat drawing without perspective.
- Evaluation: perspective, observation, life.

A3. Draw an auto-rickshaw from a 3/4 front view.

- Consider: the three wheels, single headlight (older models) or twin, canopy, meter, driver seat, passenger bench.
- Composition: 2-point perspective.
- Idea: add a driver and a passenger to show scale.
- Mistakes: four wheels; wrong canopy shape.
- Evaluation: form, proportion, detail.

A4. Draw your school's main gate at 8 am.

- Consider: guard, students, parents, vehicles, vendors.
- Composition: a frontal or angled perspective.
- Idea: show the morning rush.
- Mistakes: an empty scene.
- Evaluation: observation, activity, depth.

A5. Draw a vegetable vendor's cart with at least 8 identifiable vegetables.

- Consider: the weighing scale, umbrella, cart wheels, vendor, customer.
- Composition: 2-point perspective.
- Idea: show bargaining.
- Mistakes: vegetables that can't be identified.
- Evaluation: identifiability, colour, story.

A6. Draw a bicycle accurately, side view.

- Consider: the diamond frame, chain on the right, pedals, brakes, carrier, bell, stand.
- Composition: side elevation with accurate proportion.

- Idea: add a milk can on the carrier for context.
- Mistakes: the chain on the wrong side; a missing front fork; wrong frame triangles.
- Evaluation: accuracy.

A7. Draw a ceiling fan as seen from directly below it.

- Consider: the hub, 3 blades with a radial arrangement, the canopy, the down-rod foreshortened.
- Idea: show motion blur in one version.
- Mistakes: drawing a side view instead.
- Evaluation: viewpoint accuracy.

A8. Draw the dining table of your house after dinner.

- Consider: utensils, leftovers, cloth, objects that tell a story about the family.
- Idea: details that reveal the people.
- Mistakes: a sterile, empty table.
- Evaluation: storytelling through objects.

A9. Draw a "product you love" and write 200 words about it (DAT 2026, reported).

- Consider: the object's form, material, function, emotion, sustainability, and one improvement.
- Composition: a big 3/4 view + a small in-use frame; the text in a neat block.
- Idea: choose a humble, meaningful product (tiffin, grandfather's radio, a pencil box) over a flashy phone.
- Mistakes: an iPhone with generic text; going over or under the word count.
- Evaluation: drawing quality, depth of observation, writing structure (see Vol 2B §3.5).

A10. Illustrate a glass of shikanji or thandai with its ingredients (DAT 2026, reported).

- Consider: the vessel, condensation, ingredients arranged around it, the context (street cart or festival), labels.
- Composition: the vessel at a thirds point; ingredients in an arc.
- Idea: an "ingredients journey" with arrows into the glass.
- Mistakes: no colour; ingredients unlabelled.
- Evaluation: appetite appeal, accuracy, layout.

A11. Draw a market scene during a power cut at night.

- Consider: light sources (candles, phone torches, petromax lamps, an inverter-lit shop), long shadows.
- Composition: strong value contrast.
- Idea: one shop with an inverter glowing, the others dark.
- Mistakes: lighting the whole scene evenly.
- Evaluation: handling of light and shadow, mood.

A12. Draw your study table as it is right now, without tidying.

- Consider: honesty, clutter, the materials.
- Idea: a revealing self-portrait through objects.
- Evaluation: observation, composition.

B. Scenes & Perspective (B1–B14)

B1. A three-storey building with life on every floor (DAT 2026 theme, reported).

- Consider: a section view; different activities on each floor (ground: a shop; 1st: a family; 2nd: a student; terrace: water tanks and clothes lines); a staircase linking them.
- Composition: frontal 1-point; stack the floors.
- Idea: one character moving between floors (e.g. a cat chasing a ball down the stairs) ties it together.
- Mistakes: inconsistent floor heights; tiny people.
- Evaluation: perspective, proportion, storytelling.

B2. A railway platform as a train arrives, from the footbridge.

- Consider: bird's-eye (3-point downward), the train roof, the crowd surging, porters, the tea vendor.
- Mistakes: wrong VP placement.
- Evaluation: viewpoint, crowd handling.

B3. A flooded street during the monsoon.

- Consider: water levels on people (ankle/knee), reflections, umbrellas, rickshaws, plastic sheets over shops, kids playing with paper boats.
- Evaluation: atmosphere, observation.

B4. A government hospital OPD waiting area.

- Consider: queues, a token display, a fan, posters, a wheelchair, anxious faces.
- Idea: highlight one design problem (e.g. no seating for the elderly).
- Evaluation: empathy, observation.

B5. A wedding procession (baraat) in a narrow lane.

- Consider: the band, the groom on a horse, lights carried by workers, onlookers on balconies.
- Composition: 1-point down the lane.
- Evaluation: energy, depth.

B6. A view from inside a moving bus window.

- Consider: a frame within a frame, motion blur outside, the passengers' reflections.
- Evaluation: viewpoint creativity.

B7. A rooftop on Uttarayan / Makar Sankranti (kite festival).

- Consider: bird's-eye or rooftop level; many kites; people with spools; the neighbouring rooftops.
- Evaluation: perspective, crowd, colour.

B8. A school sports day seen from the top of the stands.

- Consider: track lanes in perspective, crowds, flags.
- Evaluation: perspective of curved lanes.

B9. A street-food lane at 9 pm.

- Consider: light from stalls, steam, signage, crowds.
- Evaluation: lighting, density.

B10. The view an ant sees on a picnic mat.

- Consider: worm's-eye; giant food items; legs like towers.
- Evaluation: scale manipulation, imagination.

B11. The interior of a traditional Indian kitchen vs a modular kitchen (split frame).

- Consider: a chulha / tawa vs a chimney and hob; floor-seated vs standing work.
- Evaluation: observation, comparison.

B12. A post office queue (or bank queue) and its problems.

- Consider: annotate the pain points; propose a fix in an inset.
- Evaluation: problem identification.

B13. A village well or handpump in the evening.

- Consider: women with pots, children, animals, the setting sun, long shadows.
- Evaluation: composition, light.

B14. A metro station entrance seen from below, at street level.

- Consider: worm's-eye; 3-point upward perspective.
- Evaluation: technical perspective.

C. Sequential & Storytelling (C1–C14)

C1. Six frames: helping an elderly person who falls on a morning walk (DAT 2026, reported).

- See the worked plan in §10.
- Evaluation: continuity, emotion, an empathy-driven resolution.

C2. Four frames: the life cycle of a plastic bottle.

- Consider: manufacture → use → discard → (a) ocean or (b) recycled into a T-shirt; an alternative ending.
- Evaluation: clarity, message.

C3. Five frames: making chai at a roadside stall.

- Consider: a process drawing, ingredients, hands close up, steam, serving.
- Evaluation: process accuracy, shot variety.

C4. Four frames: a lost child at a mela finds their parents.

- Evaluation: emotion, the solution (an announcement booth, a wristband).

C5. Six frames: a day in the life of a school bag.

- Consider: personification, the bag's viewpoint.
- Evaluation: imagination, continuity.

C6. Four frames: a seed becoming a tree that shades a bus stop.

- Consider: the passage of time (seasons).
- Evaluation: time depiction.

C7. Six frames: preparing for and celebrating Diwali, with a twist about safety or pollution.

- Evaluation: a story arc and its message.

C8. Four frames: how a letter or parcel reaches your home.

- Consider: the system: post box → sorting → transport → postman.
- Evaluation: process understanding.

C9. Three frames: before, during and after a cyclone in a coastal village.

- Evaluation: atmosphere, consequence, recovery.

C10. Five frames: an origami crane being folded (process drawing).

- Consider: clear steps with arrows (instructional).
- Evaluation: instructional clarity.

C11. Four frames: a stray dog's rainy night.

- Evaluation: empathy, mood.

C12. Six frames: a wordless story titled "The Umbrella".

- Idea: sharing an umbrella with a stranger.
- Evaluation: storytelling without words.

C13. Four frames: grandparents learning to use a smartphone.

- Consider: humour, frustration, success; the design insight (bigger icons).
- Evaluation: emotion, insight.

C14. Four frames: how a potter makes a matka.

- Consider: the craft process (wedging, throwing on the wheel, drying, firing).
- Evaluation: knowledge of the craft, process.

D. Product Design / Redesign (D1–D16)

D1. Items to carry while travelling with your grandmother; sketch and organise them (DAT 2026, reported).

- Consider: medicines, spectacles, a shawl, water, a cushion, documents, a phone with large numbers, snacks, a walking stick, a pill timer; plus a carry solution.
- Composition: a flat-lay "knolling" (items arranged in a neat grid) + one organiser product.
- Idea: a colour-coded travel pouch with large-print labels.
- Mistakes: listing items without design thought.
- Evaluation: empathy, completeness, organisation.

D2. Redesign a bucket and mug for an elderly person with arthritis.

- Consider: grip diameter, weight, a pouring spout, a non-slip base, wheels.
- Evaluation: ergonomics, feasibility.

D3. Design a school bag that reduces back strain.

- Consider: weight distribution, a waist belt, compartments, a trolley mode for stairs.
- Evaluation: user insight.

D4. Design a dustbin that encourages waste segregation in apartments.

- Consider: colour coding (green = wet, blue = dry, red/black = hazardous), foot pedal, odour control.
- Evaluation: behaviour design.

D5. Redesign a street vendor's cart for a pani-puri seller.

- Consider: hygiene, water storage, waste, shade, mobility, lighting, a payment QR.

- Evaluation: context, multi-function.

D6. Design a seat for a crowded local train that holds more people standing comfortably.

- Consider: lean bars, foldable seats, handles at different heights.
- Evaluation: space efficiency.

D7. Solve the neem-branch problem: a tree branch overhangs between two neighbours and its leaves fall into both homes (DAT 2025, reported).

- Consider: both neighbours' interests, the tree's value (shade, medicine), possible solutions: a shared leaf-catching net that funnels into a compost pit; a schedule; pruning without killing the tree; a shared seating area beneath it.
- Composition: plan view + elevation + a happy-ending frame.
- Mistakes: cutting the tree as the only solution.
- Evaluation: empathy for both sides, sustainability, creativity.

D8. Design a kit for a first-time train traveller who can't read.

- Consider: icons, a colour-coded ticket holder, a seat-finding guide.
- Evaluation: inclusive design.

D9. Design a wash-basin solution for a train coach that prevents water wastage and spillage.

- Consider: the problems in a train sink (spills while the train moves, clogging, low pressure, height, hygiene): a push tap with metered flow, a deep basin with splash guard, a foot-operated pump.
- Evaluation: problem identification (the 2025 paper reportedly had a train-based problem question), solution feasibility.

D10. Redesign a hospital drip stand for patients who need to walk.

- Evaluation: mobility, stability.

D11. Design a lunchbox that keeps food warm without electricity.

- Consider: vacuum insulation, a hay-box principle, a thermal sleeve.
- Evaluation: technical insight.

D12. Design an umbrella for two-wheeler riders.

- Consider: safety (no visibility blockage), wind, mounting, legal concerns.
- Evaluation: critical thinking (an alternative may be a better raincoat).

D13. Design a toy for a visually impaired child.

- Consider: sound, texture, shape, safety.
- Evaluation: inclusivity, multisensory approach.

D14. Design a footwear stand for a temple that prevents mix-ups.

- Consider: a token system, cubbies, colour or number coding.
- Evaluation: systems thinking.

D15. Redesign a ration-shop (PDS) queue experience.

- Consider: token numbers, shade, seating, an SMS alert.
- Evaluation: service design.

D16. Design a water bottle for a construction worker.

- Consider: durability, large capacity, a strap, refill ease, labelling.
- Evaluation: user specificity.

E. Visual Communication: Posters (E1–E10)

E1. Poster for an orange-juice corner from a crow's point of view (DAT 2025, reported).

- Consider: elevated perspective; the circular orange glass seen from above like a sun; a crow on a wire looking down; bold headline.
- Mistakes: ignoring the viewpoint constraint.
- Evaluation: viewpoint execution, appetite appeal, hierarchy.

E2. Poster: "Save Water" without showing a tap or a drop.

- Idea: avoid the clichés, e.g. a cracked earth map shaped like India.
- Evaluation: originality.

E3. Poster for a classical-music concert (Hindustani) at a heritage venue.

- Consider: tanpura curves as visual rhythm; elegant type.
- Evaluation: mood, typography.

E4. Road safety poster for helmet use, aimed at teenagers.

- Consider: humour or shock; youth language.
- Evaluation: audience fit.

E5. Poster announcing a local craft fair featuring Warli art.

- Consider: Warli style (circle, triangle, square, white on terracotta).
- Evaluation: cultural accuracy.

E6. Poster: "Digital Detox Weekend."

- Evaluation: concept, metaphor.

E7. Poster for a blood-donation camp.

- Consider: red as accent only; white space.
- Evaluation: hierarchy, restraint.

E8. Poster for a lost-and-found campaign at a railway station.

- Evaluation: information design.

E9. Poster celebrating your city's food (one dish as a hero).

- Evaluation: appetite appeal, place identity.

E10. Poster: "Stop Single-Use Plastic" with a maximum of 3 colours.

- Evaluation: constraint handling.

F. Symbols, Logos & Pictograms (F1–F10)

F1. A logo for a waste-pickers' cooperative.

- Consider: dignity, circularity; a hand + a recycle-arrow combination.
- Evaluation: meaning, simplicity.

F2. A symbol for "quiet zone" near hospitals that works without text.

- Evaluation: universality.

F3. A set of 6 pictograms for a railway station (toilet, drinking water, ticket counter, enquiry, waiting room, exit).

- Consider: consistent style, grid, line weight.
- Evaluation: system consistency.

F4. A logo for a bamboo-furniture startup from Assam.

- Evaluation: material and region references.

F5. A logo using negative space for a bookstore named "Owl".

- Evaluation: clever use of negative space.

F6. A symbol representing "accessibility for all" for a museum.

- Evaluation: going beyond the wheelchair cliché.

F7. A monogram from your initials, in 3 styles (classical, modern, playful).

- Evaluation: typographic range.

F8. A logo for a monsoon festival.

- Evaluation: mood, simplicity.

F9. A pictogram set for a school playground's rules.

- Evaluation: child readability.

F10. A symbol for "women-only compartment" that avoids stereotypes.

- Evaluation: sensitivity.

G. Signage & Wayfinding (G1–G6)

G1. Design 5 signboards for narrow streets (DAT 2026, reported).

- Consider:
  - one-way
  - no four-wheelers
  - dead end
  - low wires overhead
  - public tap / toilet
  - silence near a school
  - pedestrians first
  - shop directions
- Mounting: projecting blade signs at about 2.4 m, visible at night (reflective).
- Composition: a 5-sign system + 1 in-context drawing.
- Evaluation: consistency, clarity, contextual placement.

G2. A signage system for a large government hospital.

- Evaluation: colour coding by department, legibility.

G3. A bilingual (or trilingual) name sign for a heritage monument.

- Evaluation: typography balancing scripts.

G4. Wayfinding for a village weekly market (haat).

- Evaluation: low-cost materials, icon use.

G5. Emergency evacuation signage for a school.

- Evaluation: standard colour (green for exit), arrows.

G6. A bus-stop information panel for first-time visitors.

- Evaluation: information hierarchy.

H. Packaging (H1–H6)

H1. Eco-friendly packaging for 6 eggs for a village co-op.

- Consider: moulded pulp, a leaf, a cloth sling, protection.
- Evaluation: protection, sustainability.

H2. Packaging for a set of 4 handmade Channapatna toys.

- Consider: a window to show the toys, craft storytelling.
- Evaluation: brand story.

H3. A reusable packaging system for a food-delivery app.

- Evaluation: a return system, hygiene.

H4. Packaging for Darjeeling tea as a gift.

- Evaluation: premium feel, GI identity.

H5. Packaging for medicine for the elderly that prevents dosage mistakes.

- Evaluation: calendar-strip design, large print.

H6. Packaging for a single samosa that keeps it crisp.

- Evaluation: vent holes, grease resistance.

I. Imagination & Unusual Situations (I1–I12)

I1. What if gravity reversed for 10 minutes in your classroom?

- Evaluation: imagination, details, humour.

I2. Draw a creature that is half-elephant, half-kettle, and show where it lives.

- Evaluation: a believable hybrid.

I3. Your city in 2075 after sea levels rise by 1 m.

- Evaluation: speculative design, adaptation.

I4. If trees could talk, what would the neem tree outside your house say? Draw it as a comic.

- Evaluation: personality, message.

I5. A day when all colours disappeared except one.

- Evaluation: concept, colour use.

I6. A house for a family of birds designed by humans (or for humans designed by birds).

- Evaluation: role reversal.

I7. Draw "time" without drawing a clock.

- Evaluation: abstraction.

I8. Draw the sound of a pressure-cooker whistle.

- Evaluation: synaesthesia, visual sound.

I9. Draw "silence."

- Evaluation: abstraction, negative space.

I10. You shrink to 2 cm and land in your kitchen. Draw what you see.

- Evaluation: scale, perspective.

I11. A vehicle for a family of 5 in 2050 Indian cities.

- Evaluation: future thinking, user needs.

I12. Your favourite festival celebrated on Mars.

- Evaluation: adaptation, humour.

J. Social, Environmental & Sustainable Design Problems (J1–J10)

J1. Show 4 problems faced by a street vendor during summer, and solve one.

- Evaluation: problem identification and a solution.

J2. Design a solution for stray-cattle collisions on highways at night.

- Evaluation: low-cost systemic ideas (reflective collars).

J3. Reduce food waste at Indian weddings: visualise a system.

- Evaluation: systems thinking.

J4. Design shade and seating for traffic police at junctions.

- Evaluation: empathy, feasibility.

J5. Help a school with no electricity keep classrooms cool.

- Evaluation: passive cooling (jaali, khus curtains, white roofs).

J6. Design a system for rainwater harvesting in an apartment, explained visually.

- Evaluation: technical clarity.

J7. Make public toilets safer and cleaner for women: show your ideas.

- Evaluation: sensitivity, practical detail.

J8. Upcycle 50 used plastic bottles into something useful for a school.

- Evaluation: originality, construction detail.

J9. Design a way for migrant workers to send money and messages home easily.

- Evaluation: service design, low literacy.

J10. Reduce noise pollution during festivals without killing the joy.

- Evaluation: balanced, creative.

K. Colour, Pattern & Composition Exercises (K1–K6)

K1. Fill a 10×10 cm square with a pattern inspired by Ajrakh, using only 3 colours.

- Evaluation: rhythm, cultural reference.

K2. Show the same street in a warm palette (festival morning) and a cool palette (rainy night).

- Evaluation: colour mood.

K3. Create an abstract composition expressing "traffic jam" using only geometric shapes.

- Evaluation: abstraction.

K4. Design a border pattern for a sari inspired by your city's architecture.

- Evaluation: motif development.

K5. Make a composition with 5 circles showing tension.

- Evaluation: use of principles.

K6. Recolour a familiar logo in a monochrome scheme and explain the change in mood.

- Evaluation: colour theory.

L. Writing-plus-Drawing (L1–L4)

L1. Describe your favourite street in 150 words and draw its most interesting corner.
L2. Write a 6-word story and illustrate it.
L3. Write a product review of a public bench (100 words) with a redesign sketch.
L4. Write a letter from a discarded chair to its designer (120 words) with an illustration.

- For L1–L4, evaluation: concise descriptive writing, a coherent relationship between text and image, and creativity.

Total prompts: 12 + 14 + 14 + 16 + 10 + 10 + 6 + 6 + 12 + 10 + 6 + 4 = 120.

Self-scoring rubric for any prompt (out of 10)

Criterion	0	1	2
Followed instructions (count, viewpoint, constraints)	missed	partly	fully
Idea (relevance + originality)	cliché / off-topic	sensible	fresh and fitting
Observation & detail	generic	some	rich, believable
Composition & proportion	poor	acceptable	strong
Communication (clarity, labels, writing)	confusing	readable	instantly clear

Score bands: 9–10 = excellent; 7–8 = strong; 5–6 = developing; below 5 = redo the prompt within 3 days. These are practice benchmarks, not NID's actual scoring.

NEXT VOLUME: Volume 4 — Massive Question Bank (`04A-…` through `04G-…`)